

Predicting First Impressions with Visual Complexity and Colorfulness

Verified reference summary • Year: 2013 • Source bibliography: docs/REFERENCES.md

What the paper contributes

Reinecke and collaborators model perceived visual complexity and colorfulness from image statistics and connect those measures to first-impression judgments. The paper shows that visual richness matters, not merely absence of defects.

Method / evaluation stance

slidekit uses this idea carefully. Because it does not render pixels for scoring, it cannot reproduce screenshot-based colorfulness exactly. Instead, it approximates richness through theme color variety, accent use, and structural visual engagement.

How slidekit uses it

This is a useful compromise for production. A deck that is lint-clean but visually empty should not receive the same advisory score as a deck with well-controlled emphasis and structure.

YAML vs HTML takeaway

HTML/screenshots are superior when the research question is final perceived colorfulness or image complexity. YAML/theme metrics are superior when the goal is deterministic guidance an agent can act on immediately.

Bottom line

The paper supports a pragmatic split: use research-style rendered artifacts when the question depends on final pixels or human preference collection, but keep slidekit production decks in a constrained YAML IR so layout, linting, and agent fixes remain deterministic, inspectable, and cheap.

Primary slidekit mapping	balance / alignment / whitespace / overlap / contrast / richness / consistency, depending on the paper
Operational risk	HTML metrics can drift with rendering environment; YAML metrics can miss pixel-only effects. Use each where it is strongest.